tion No:

ID: _____

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Name: _____

Faculty of Business Studies

B325

Managing across organisational and cultural boundaries

Final Exam/Version B

2024-2025 / Summer

3-Sep-2025

Number of Exam Pages: 12 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 3 hours**

PLEASE READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS

Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF**" mode throughout the examination.
This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
This Final exam will be marked out of 100 marks and is worth 50% of the total mark of B325 course.
Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches.
Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examination.
Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
Any work crossed through will **NOT** be marked.
Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY

Question No.	Mark	Marker's Signature
Q1		
Q2		
Q3		

ments (FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY):

Total: ____ 100

Final M

SECTION ONE (40 MARKS)

CamScanner

You should attempt ALL questions in this section.

Case Study: Leadership Integration at GulfTech Solutions (UAE)

GulfTech Solutions, an Emirati technology services company, has recently formed a strategic partnership a Scandinavian software firm. As part of the agreement, joint teams and managerial exchanges have implemented across both firms. While Emirati leaders emphasize relationship-building, consensus, hierarchical respect, their Scandinavian counterparts operate in a flat structure with direct feedback and driven performance metrics.

Misalignment has already occurred in cross-border project teams, especially regarding leadership communication style, and team decision-making. GulfTech's executive board has commissioned a repo how to manage leadership integration in such culturally diverse teams.

Q1a. Identify key leadership style differences between Arab and Scandinavian cultures using cultural theory. (10 Marks)

CamScanner

Q1b. Evaluate the challenges and benefits of managing bicultural teams in a strategic partnership. (10 Marks)

CamScanner

Q1c. Assess how cultural intelligence and training can reduce conflict and improve team cohesion. (10 Marks)

CamScanner

Q1d. Recommend strategies GulfTech can implement to ensure mutual leadership learning and global team success. (10 Marks)

CamScanner

- Effectively integrates HRM theory (e.g., Perlmutter's EPRG model, Hofstede)	5 Marks	
- Supports arguments with real-world or case-based examples	5 Marks	
Total	**30 Marks**	

SECTION THREE (30 MARKS)

(TMA Reflection Question):

As part of your assignment, you analyzed the cross-cultural integration process of Innova Tech Solutions as it expanded into Brazil, Saudi Arabia, and China. Reflect on the challenges that arose due to differences in organizational structures and cultural values. How did you apply frameworks such as Hofstede's cultural dimensions to understand the clash between decentralized Western management styles? In what ways did this analysis help you interpret communication breakdowns, resistance to change, and team cohesion issues? What strategies did you recommend to improve cultural alignment and operational integration? Finally, what challenges did you encounter in conducting this cultural analysis, and how did you overcome them to produce culturally sensitive recommendations?

CamScanner